

THE PROBLEM SOLVING PLANNER

When something feels stuck, don't solve everything at once.

Sometimes a problem feels bigger because we're trying to figure out everything at the same time.

This planner helps you break one problem into smaller, more manageable steps.

A NAME THE PROBLEM

What exactly needs to change?

Try to describe the problem in one clear sentence.

I need to decide whether to _____

I need to figure out how to _____

My problem: _____

B WHAT CAN I ACTUALLY CONTROL?

Separate what is yours to work with.

I CAN CONTROL: _____

I CANNOT CONTROL: _____

My focus:

Try to describe the problem in one clear sentence.

C THINK OF YOUR OPTIONS

Don't look for the perfect answer.

Come up with at least 3 possible ways forward.

Option 1: _____

Option 2: _____

Option 3: _____

D LOOK AT EACH OPTION

For each option, ask:

What could this help me achieve?

What could make it difficult?

What would I need to make it work?

E CHOOSE YOUR FIRST STEP

You don't have to solve the entire problem today.

Which option feels realistic enough to try first?

I choose: _____

My first step is: _____

I will do it by: _____

F REVIEW, DON'T JUDGE

After you've tried your first step:

What happened?

What worked?

What didn't?

What could I change or try next?

REMEMBER

A problem doesn't always need one perfect solution.
Sometimes, it needs one workable next step.